

Brand Guidance

Standardizing FEMA's brand will unify, strengthen and energize the Agency's communications and stakeholder engagement efforts and foster a consistent messaging describing what we do and how we serve the public.

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Brand Nomenclature

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The principals behind FEMA's brand are:

- A single public-facing identity applied across all FEMA communications.
- One shared vision, mission, tag line visual presentation (color palette, typefaces, graphic elements), and voice that reinforces consistency in service and reputation for stakeholders in alignment with DHS Directive 123-06.
- FEMA materials are designed to meet 508 compliance to be accessible to all.
- A focus on serving our customers, with an emphasis on access to products and services versus our organizational hierarchy.

Branding Attribution

Speaking with 'one voice' means that most products and materials will be branded under FEMA, instead of being branded to divisions. As part of this brand nomenclature, specific products and services will be emphasized - using plain language - not the organizational entity within FEMA that provides the product.

This approach will leverage the name recognition of FEMA, as is often illustrated by stakeholders asking for a specific product by name, while aligning to consistent FEMA branding.

Co-branding

Co-branding may be established in situations where FEMA has entered into a **formal partnership (Contract, Memorandum of Understanding or Memorandum of Agreement)** with another organization or division.



FEMA

CO-BRANDING WITH FEDERAL PARTNERS

Co-branding with another agency entails the depiction of the FEMA logo beside another organization logo. Co-branded requests must be approved by the Director of External affairs or his/her designee. See the FEMA Design Guide for guidance on logo placement.

CO-BRANDING WITHIN THE AGENCY

Offices and divisions are allowed to have an **Approved FEMA Co-Branding Mark**. These Co-branded marks are allowed to be used on both internal and external products as they follow our guidance of referencing FEMA first, followed by the office name. The Co-branded Marks are created by offices or offices plus the division name under it. Any office or division seeking to use their own logo or mark outside of the approved FEMA Co-branded mark, must have written approval by the Director of External Affairs or his/her designee.

FEMA CO-Branded Mark Example

 FEMA	OFFICE OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS	 FEMA	OFFICE OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS
 FEMA	OFFICE OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS Communications Division	 FEMA	OFFICE OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS Communications Division

Guidance

Do's	Don'ts
- External/Internal Graphics - External/Internal Brochures - PDF External/Internal Factsheets	Don't put on the outside of a report document but you can include it on the inside. You should use the only the FEMA logo that is already built-in into the template.

Do's	Don'ts
▪ If this is a factsheet that is added to the site as direct web copy in the factsheet content type, the mark will not be added it. ▪ If it a Factsheet that is uploaded as pdf you can have it on your document. ▪ Front Slide of External/Internal Presentations ▪ Gov Delivery Emails	

Sub-brands

Sub-brands may be established to support programs and capabilities that are distinct from the parent brand, to include a distinct mission, customers, capabilities and responsibilities. External Affairs will use the following criteria to determine if an offering will be established as a sub-brand:

1. Alignment of offering – does the program, product or capability compliment or compete with other FEMA programs, products or capabilities?
2. Target audience – is there a well-defined primary customer base that is separate from FEMA's customer base?
3. External considerations – are there external forces, to include stakeholder expectations, legislative direction, or other considerations that indicate usefulness of establishing a separate brand?
4. Presently, **FEMA's ONLY approved sub-brand is: Ready**

In most cases, products and services will align with the branded house strategy. It is anticipated that sub-brands will be uncommon in FEMA's communications efforts.

SUB-BRAND EXAMPLE



Trademarks

A trademark is associated with providing a product or service in commerce. Using a logo/mark in commerce to identify the source of goods or services makes that logo/mark a trademark. A trademark can be registered at the US Patent and Trademark Office (which comes with some benefits) or a trademark can be an unregistered trademark or

common law trademark (which has some drawbacks). You can enforce both registered and unregistered trademarks, meaning that you can stop other people from using a similar mark in a similar manner.

Examples of registered trademarks at FEMA include the READY Check mark and USFA's Fire is Everyone's Fight. Programs seeking to trademark a logo must receive written approval from the Director of External Affairs or his/her designee before creating a mark.

Governance and Standards

The Office of External Affairs will establish and maintain management directives, standard operating procedures, tools and resources to ensure consistent implementation of FEMA branding. In addition to this document, guidance to support employees' application of CISA branding will include:

- [FEMA Design Style Guide](#) – outlines treatment of the FEMA seal/wordmark in alignment with [DHS Directive 123-06](#), approved colors and fonts for product development and graphic design guidelines to develop products consistent with the overall look and feel of the organization.
- [FEMA Writing Style Guide](#) – provides guidance to assist employees with adapting writing to a consistent organizational style, specifically including guidance on plain language principles; consistent application of capitalization, abbreviations and acronyms; and a lexicon of common terms used in FEMA work.
- [Templates](#) – standard formats for letterhead, fact sheets, business cards, certificates, presentations and other products used in employees' day-to-day work.

Responsibilities

The Director of External Affairs has full responsibility and authority to set standards, enforce brand consistency and establish processes for FEMA's branding efforts. This includes full authority to:

- Establish policy for branding and communications activities across FEMA.
- Determine program identities or sub-brands through the established criteria.
- Approve use of the FEMA seal and wordmark, with the exception of issuance of credentials, in coordination with the DHS Office of Public Affairs as outlined [in DHS Directive 123-06](#).
- Establish house style guidelines and associated templates in coordination with DHS OPA.
- Oversee all digital engagement activities including internet sites and social media identities.
- Approve the launch of new internal or external publications, visual imagery and digital products.

Division and program leadership will ensure that all employees consistently apply the standards associated with FEMA's branding and communications. Programs will develop, execute and evaluate all products to meet

operational and programmatic goals and requirements in alignment with these established processes and guidelines.